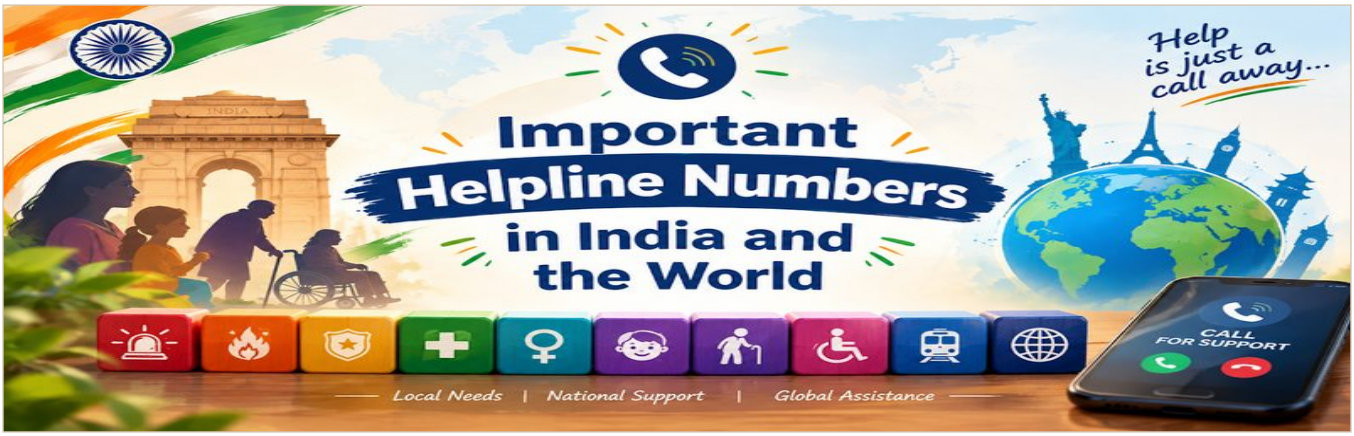


Akella Raghavendra Sir
Founder & Chief Mentor

[GS PAPER I – INDIAN SOCIETY | GS PAPER III – INTERNAL SECURITY | GS PAPER III – SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY | GS PAPER IV – ETHICS]

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Important helpline numbers in India and the world



Explore key helpline numbers in India and around the world for emergencies, safety, healthcare, citizen services, and specialised support. A quick-reference guide to essential helplines that every citizen should know and save for times of need.

Important Helpline Numbers in India and the World

Syllabus areas:

- **GS Paper I – Indian Society:** Vulnerable Sections of Society
- **GS Paper III – Internal Security:** Cyber Security
- **GS Paper III – Science & Technology:** Information Technology
- **GS Paper IV – Ethics:** Probity in Governance

Helplines are dedicated telephone services that provide citizens with **emergency assistance, information, grievance redressal, counselling, protection and access to government services**. Their administration may be national, state-specific, or jointly implemented by Central and State authorities.

1098 – CHILDLINE – first launched helpline in India

- **Started: 1996**
- **Area:** Child protection and assistance
- **Origin:** Began as a field-action project of the **Tata Institute of Social Sciences (TISS), Mumbai**
- **Purpose:** Assistance to children in distress, including abandoned, abused, homeless and vulnerable children.
- It later developed into a **nationwide child helpline** under the Government of India.

1. Major National Helplines in India



1. Emergency Numbers

112 – Unified Emergency Helpline Single emergency number for police, fire, ambulance and other emergency assistance across India.

1033 – NHAI Highway Helpline For emergencies and assistance on National Highways, including accidents, vehicle breakdowns and highway-related issues.

1070 – Disaster Management Helpline A toll-free number for **State/Central Relief Commissioners and State Emergency Operation Centres** to coordinate and respond to natural disasters and emergencies.

2. Women Helpline

181 – Women Helpline Provides assistance, counselling and support to women facing violence, harassment, abuse or other distress situations.

3. Child Helpline

1098 – Child Helpline A dedicated helpline for children in distress, including cases of abuse, abandonment, trafficking, exploitation and other emergencies.

4. Senior Citizens / Persons with Disabilities

14567 – Elderline National helpline for senior citizens providing information, guidance, emotional support and assistance regarding welfare and grievances.

14456 – National Disability Helpline Provides information and assistance to Persons with Disabilities regarding government schemes, disability services, rights and support mechanisms.

5. Enquiry / Citizen Services

139 – Indian Railways Helpline Provides railway-related information and assistance, including train services, passenger grievances and railway enquiries.

1947 – Aadhaar Helpline UIDAI helpline for Aadhaar-related information, enrolment, updates, authentication and other Aadhaar services.

1950 – Voter Helpline Election Commission helpline for voter registration, electoral-roll information, EPIC-related services and election-related queries.

6. Other Important Helplines

1930 – National Cyber Crime Helpline For reporting cyber financial fraud and seeking immediate assistance to prevent further loss of money.

14416 – Tele-MANAS 24×7 national tele-mental-health helpline providing counselling, psychological support and referral services.

1906 – LPG Emergency Helpline Dedicated emergency helpline for reporting LPG leakage and seeking immediate assistance.



Major Helplines Introduced During the Modi Government Period

The Government of India has introduced and strengthened several citizen-centric helplines in recent years to improve emergency response, cybercrime prevention, mental healthcare and welfare delivery.

1. 1930 – National Cyber Crime Helpline

- **Ministry:** Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)
- **Nodal Institution:** Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C)
- **Introduced:** CFCFRMS was launched in **2021**; the **1930** helpline was subsequently operationalised for assistance in reporting cyber financial fraud.
- **Purpose:** Enables citizens to report financial cyber fraud quickly and facilitates coordination with banks and law-enforcement agencies to prevent further loss of funds.

2. 14567 – Elderline

- **Ministry:** Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
- **Launched: 2021**
- **Purpose:** India's first Pan-India toll-free helpline dedicated to senior citizens. It provides information, legal and pension-related guidance, emotional support and intervention in cases of elder abuse or abandonment.
- **UPSC Linkage:** Ageing population, social justice, welfare of vulnerable sections and inclusive governance.

3. 14416 – Tele-MANAS

- **Ministry:** Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
- **Launched: 10 October 2022**
- **Purpose:** Provides **24×7 tele-mental health services** across India, including counselling, psychological support and referral services.
- **Other Number:** 1-800-891-4416
- **UPSC Linkage:** Mental health, public health, digital healthcare and accessibility of healthcare services.

4. 112 – Emergency Response Support System (ERSS)

- **Ministry:** Ministry of Home Affairs
- **National Rollout: 2018–19**
- **Purpose:** A unified emergency number integrating police, fire, health and other emergency services. It replaced the need to remember multiple emergency numbers in participating areas.

· **UPSC Linkage:** Police reforms, emergency management, technology-enabled governance and citizen-centric administration.

5. 1075 – National COVID-19 Health Helpline

· **Ministry:** Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

· **Introduced: 2020**

· **Purpose:** Provided citizens with information and guidance related to COVID-19, including symptoms, testing, treatment and government advisories.

· **UPSC Linkage:** Pandemic management, public health, disaster management and crisis communication.

2. Important Scam/Fraud-Related Helpline

1930 – Cyber Financial Fraud

This is particularly important in the context of the growing **digital economy and online scams**.

Citizens can report financial cyber fraud through **1930** and the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal. The CFCFRMS enables rapid reporting and coordination with banks, financial intermediaries and State/UT law-enforcement agencies to help prevent further loss.

3. National vs State Helplines

Not every helpline number in India is centrally controlled.

National helplines: Generally operate across India and are established by Central institutions/agencies.

State helplines: Operated by State Governments for state-specific services such as electricity, public grievances, transport and local administration.

Implementation can also be shared. For example, cybercrime is a State subject for investigation and prosecution, while the Central Government provides national mechanisms such as I4C, NCRP and CFCFRMS.

Therefore, UPSC aspirants should distinguish between **"national number" and "centrally administered service."**

4. Unique International Helpline System

A particularly interesting international example is the **European Union's 116 numbering range**.

The **116 series** is reserved for harmonised social-value services:

- **116 000** – Missing Children
- **116 111** – Child Helpline
- **116 123** – Emotional Support
- **116 006** – Victims of Crime
- **116 016** – Violence against Women
- **116 117** – Non-emergency Medical Assistance

This is significant because several European countries use **harmonised numbers for similar social services**, facilitating easier access across borders.

Other internationally recognised emergency numbers include:

- **911 – USA:** Police, fire and medical emergencies
- **999 – UK:** Police, fire and ambulance
- **000 – Australia:** Emergency services
- **111 – New Zealand:** Emergency services
- **112 – European Union:** Emergency services